

LEC13 - Relationships and Families

Nuclear Families

Nuclear Family: Consists of a cohabitating man and women who maintain a socially approved sexual relationship and have at least one child

Non-Nuclear Families:

Trend in the Family

- Age of first marriage is rising
 - People focus more on careers and education
 - Bad housing market
 - Less people are getting married
 - Less social pressure to get married
 - Weddings are expensive
 - Declining divorce rates
 - Less people are married
 - More women are having children in their thirties
 - The number of children per family has dropped below the replacement rate
-

Relationships

- Emerged in 18th century
 - Source of liberty, pursuit of happiness, and freedom of choice
 - Autonomy from family and greater independence, rise of family home, and shifts in cultural norms
 - Pure relationships
 - Interests and need of others rather than law, tradition, and necessity
-

Social factors

- Who you enter into a relationship with conforms to well-established rules outlined by social scientists
- Culture, socioeconomic resources, race, status, and group membership are all important factors that determine partners
- Non-random, and not entirely based on romantic notions of love
- Third party pressure from friends and family discourage the crossing of social boundaries
 - "Dating down"
 - Marrying outside religion or race

Homogamy: Marriage between people who are similar

LEC13 - Relationships and Families

- Homogamy in education is one of the strongest findings across the world
 - Assortive mating and assortive meetings

Assortive Mating: Non-random matching of people into relationships

Research on Marriage:

- Select partners based on similarities in education, attractiveness, resources, race, religion, and culture
 - Dissimilarity leads to lower quality and shorter relationships
-

Online Dating

- Eclipsed all other ways of meeting people
- Young people, LGBTQ+ people, and middle aged people date online
- Like offline dating, mostly conforms to homogamy around class, education, race, and attractiveness
- Functionality of online dating sites encourage adoption of market orientation towards dating
- Influences communication, filtering ,and presentation of self
- Shopping mentality
- Based off rational control, rather than unpredictable non-rational factors like chemistry and emotion

Decision Making in Online Dating

- Exchange nature of relationship decision making
 - Exchange own assets for desirable attributes in a partner
 - Pressure to present self in attractive and desirable ways based on economic thinking
 - Changes how people think about dating by focusing on demographics and descriptions rather than social interaction and chemistry
 - May not be sustainable
 - Rational control sets users up for frustration
-

Colorism and Race

- Colorism is a form of prejudice or discrimination that is based on social meanings attached to skin tones
- Past research shows that whites and Asians have a reluctance to date partners with dark skin
- Skin tone as a predictor variable in recent studies of Asian daters
 - Darker skinned Asians are more likely to date those with darker skin
 - More likely to express preference for darker skin color partners

Thursday, March 13, 2025

LEC13 - Relationships and Families

- Could be that predicue makes them sympathetic and reluctant to reach out to lighter skinned partners due to rejection